

Cat Sudden Aggression Reintroduction Guide — Action Checklist

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IMMEDIATE SEPARATION SETUP

- ☐ **Immediate Separation Setup:** Create two separate resource zones with food, water, litter, and scented items from each cat's favorite spots, placing them in rooms where they cannot hear or see each other through walls.
- ☐ **Immediate Separation Setup:** Give each cat 15 minutes of focused one-on-one attention by sitting quietly and speaking softly while letting them approach you on their own terms.
- ☐ **Immediate Separation Setup:** Check both cats carefully for injuries around the neck, face, and base of the tail, noting any blood, swelling, or flinching when specific areas are touched.
- ☐ **Immediate Separation Setup:** Identify which cat appears more frightened, withdrawn, or injured to determine whether one cat was the target who finally snapped back rather than the actual aggressor.

MEDICAL SCREENING SIGNS

- ☐ **Medical Screening Signs:** Watch for a cat who seems "off" before the fight — less interested in food, more withdrawn, or uncharacteristically irritable in the days leading up to the incident.
- ☐ **Medical Screening Signs:** Assess whether the aggression was disproportionate to the trigger, where a normal approach from the other cat set off an extreme, chaotic reaction rather than a predictable response.
- ☐ **Medical Screening Signs:** Track inconsistency in the aggressor's behavior, noting if they are fine with you but hostile to the other cat, or tolerant in some rooms but aggressive in others.
- ☐ **Medical Screening Signs:** Look for redirected aggression opportunities, checking whether either cat had access to a window or door where they could have become agitated by an outdoor animal or perceived threat they couldn't reach.

ENVIRONMENTAL RECONSTRUCTION

- ☐ **Environmental Reconstruction:** Spend 20 minutes reconstructing the 72 hours before the fight day by day on paper or in a phone note, going through each day systematically to identify what happened.
 - ☐ **Environmental Reconstruction:** Document every household change including guests, moved furniture, new medications, altered work schedules, or routine disruptions that might have stressed one or both cats.
 - ☐ **Environmental Reconstruction:** Remember that the "sudden" fight was the final event in a stress cascade, not a random occurrence — your job is to find which stressor was the last domino to fall.
 - ☐ **Environmental Reconstruction:** Consider whether any recent construction, loud noises, neighborhood activity, or changes to your own behavior could have elevated the household stress level without your noticing.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.